

User: ursocool

Lab: Introduction to Phishing

Description: Phishing Simulation within TryHackMe that details step-by-step processes of escalating/closing tickets.

Tools: TryHackMe, Splunk

- 1) This is a false positive. The inbound email is from a third-party HR platform that is being used by the organization. We can identify this when we search for the attached link within Splunk. We can also see that the HR team is emailing the IT team because user J. Garcia has not yet received onboarding instructions from the third-party vendor despite them sending instructions.

The screenshot displays a Splunk alert interface. At the top, it says "Assigned alert(s)" with a "Write case report" button. Below this is a header for alert 8814, titled "Inbound Email Containing Suspicious External Link", with a severity of "Medium", type of "Phishing", and timestamp of "Apr 25th 2026 at 22:48".

The main section contains the following details:

- Description:** This alert was triggered by an inbound email contains one or more external links due to potentially suspicious characteristics. As part of the investigation, check firewall or proxy logs to determine whether any endpoints have attempted to access the URLs in the email and whether those connections were allowed or blocked.
- datasource:** email
- timestamp:** 04/25/2026 22:46:58.540
- subject:** Action Required: Finalize Your Onboarding Profile
- sender:** onboarding@hrconnex.thm
- recipient:** j.garcia@thetrydaily.thm
- attachment:** None
- content:** Hi Ms. Garcia,\n\nWelcome to TheTryDaily!\n\nAs part of your onboarding, please complete your final profile setup so we can configure your access.\n\nKindly please click the link below:\n\n<https://hrconnex.thm/onboarding/15400654060/j.garcia>->Set Up My Profile\n\nIf you have questions, please reach out to the HR Onboarding Team.
- direction:** inbound

At the bottom, there is a search bar "Search for an alert", a "Reset filters" button, and several filter dropdowns for "Severity", "Status", and "Alert type". It also shows "Show 15 alerts".

spunk>enterprise Apps Messages Settings Activity Help Find

Search Analytics Datasets Reports Alerts Dashboards Search & Reporting

New Search

1 hrconnex.thm 24 hour window

3 of 3 events matched No Event Sampling Job Zoom Out Zoom to Selection Deselect 1 hour per column

Events (3) Patterns Statistics Visualization

Format Timeline Zoom Out Zoom to Selection Deselect

List Format 50 Per Page

Hide Fields	All Fields	Time	Event
SELECTED FIELDS - a host 1 - a source 1 - a sourcetype 1 INTERESTING FIELDS - a attachment 1 - a content 2 - a datasource 1 - a direction 2 - a index 1 - a linecount 1 - a punct 2 - a recipient 2 - a sender 2 - a splunk_server 1 - a subject 2 - a timestamp 3 + Extract New Fields		4/25/26 9:52:57.540 PM	<pre>{ [-] attachment: None content: Hi Ms. Garcia,\n\nWelcome to TheTryDaily!\n\nAs part of your onboarding, please complete your final profile setup so we can configure your access.\n\nKindly click the link below:\n\nhttps://hrconnex.thm/onboarding/15480654868/J.garciaSet Up My Profile\n\nIf you have questions, please reach out to the HR Onboarding Team. datasource: email direction: inbound recipient: j.garcia@thetrydaily.thm sender: onboarding@hrconnex.thm subject: Action Required: Finalize Your Onboarding Profile timestamp: 04/25/2026 22:52:57.540 }</pre> Show as raw text host = 10.10.108.96.8989 source = eventcollector sourcetype = _json
		4/25/26 9:48:31.540 PM	<pre>{ [-] attachment: None content: Hi IT Team,\n\nHope you're doing well! I'm reaching out because one of our new hires, J. Garcia, hasn't received her onboarding email from hrconnex.thm, which is our new third-party HR partner for handling account setup and paperwork.\n\nHe was supposed to receive a link to complete her profile and sign some documents, but it hasn't come through - not in her inbox or spam. We've double-checked the email address on our end, and it's correct.\n\nLet me know if you need any more info from my side.\n\n datasource: email direction: internal recipient: j.carter@thetrydaily.thm sender: h.harris@thetrydaily.thm subject: Unable to Receive Onboarding Email from hrconnex.thm timestamp: 04/25/2026 22:48:31.540 }</pre> Show as raw text host = 10.10.108.96.8989 source = eventcollector sourcetype = _json
		4/25/26	{ [-]

Incident report

Incident classification ☐ True positive ☒ False positive

Closure rationale

Explain why you have identified this incident as a false positive.

B I U A

Time of Activity: Apr 25th 2026 at 17:49

List of Related Entities: email

Reason for Classifying as False Positive: Email logs shows that user J. Garcia is has not received their onboarding email from `hrconnex.thm`, which is the new third-party HR platform being used. Therefore, the link sent is a true link.

- 2) This is a true positive. This email seems to be emulating Amazon. We can identify that this is phishing email as the sender cannot be recognized/seems to copy

Amazon emails, there is a sense of urgency within the tone of the email, and most significantly when we further investigate this link within virus total, it shows as being phishing as per phishing database. This link was already blocked by the firewall, so no further escalation needed, but the user may need to be re-educated on phishing.

8815	Inbound Email Containing Suspicious External Link ^	Medium	Phishing	Apr 25th 2026 at 22:52	👤
Description:		This alert was triggered by an inbound email contains one or more external links due to potentially suspicious characteristics. As part of the investigation, check firewall or proxy logs to determine whether any endpoints have attempted to access the URLs in the email and whether those connections were allowed or blocked.			
datasource:		email			
timestamp:		04/25/2026 22:50:11.540			
subject:		Your Amazon Package Couldn't Be Delivered - Action Required			
sender:		urgents@amazon.biz			
recipient:		h.harris@thetrydaily.thm			
attachment:		None			
content:		Dear Customer,\n\nWe were unable to deliver your package due to an incomplete address.\n\nPlease confirm your shipping information by clicking the link below:\nhttp://bit.ly/3sHkX3da12340\n\nIf we don't hear from you within 48 hours, your package will be returned to sender.\n\nThank you,\n\nAmazon Delivery			
direction:		inbound			

splunk-enterpriseApps

MessagesSettingsActivityHelpFind

SearchAnalyticsDatasetsReportsAlertsDashboards

Search & Reporting

New Search

Save AsCreate Table ViewClose

1http://bit.ly/3sHkX3da1234024 hour window

1 of 1 event matchedNo Event SamplingJobVerbose Mode

Events (1)PatternsStatisticsVisualization

Format TimelineZoom OutZoom to SelectionDeselect1 hour per column

< Hide FieldsAll Fields

SELECTED FIELDS

host 1

source 1

sourcetype 1

INTERESTING FIELDS

Action 1

Application 1

datasource 1

DestinationIP 1

DestinationPort 1

index 1

linecount 1

Protocol 1

punct 1

Rule 1

SourceIP 1

SourcePort 1

splunk_server 1

timestamp 1

URL 1

+ Extract New Fields

ListFormat50 Per Page

	Time	Event
>	4/25/26 9:51:25.540 PM	<pre>{ [-] Action: blocked Application: web-browsing DestinationIP: 67.199.248.11 DestinationPort: 80 Protocol: TCP Rule: Blocked Websites SourceIP: 10.10.108.96 SourcePort: 34257 URL: http://bit.ly/3sHkX3da12340 datasource: firewall timestamp: 04/25/2026 22:51:25.540 }</pre> Show as raw text host = 10.10.108.96.8989 source = eventcollector sourcetype = _json

Incident report

Incident classification

☒ True positive
 ☐ False positive

Case report

Please write a detailed report on the steps taken to analyse and contain this incident, including all relevant information and the rationale for its closure.

Time of activity: 04/25/2026 22:50:11.540

List of Affected Entities:

Reason for Classifying as True Positive: Sender is trying to emulate Amazon. When analyzing link on virustotal, the url is identified as phishing from a phishing database.

Reason for Escalating the Alert: The link has already been blocked by the firewall.

Recommended Remediation Actions: Educate user on phishing links.

List of Attack Indicators: unrecognized sender, sender is emulating Amazon, emails has a tone of urgency, link is classified as phishing by virus total

Does this alert require escalation?

☐ Yes
 ☒ No

Submit and close alerts

<http://bit.ly/3uHX3da12340>
Sign in Sign up

1

/ 91

Community Score

1/91 security vendor flagged this URL as malicious

[http://bit.ly/3uHX3da12340](#)
[bit.ly](#)

Status: 200

Content type: text/html; charset=utf-8

Last Analysis Date: 1 day ago

[text/html](#)
[trackers](#)
[iframes](#)
[external-resources](#)
[third-party-cookies](#)

DETECTION

DETAILS

COMMUNITY 16

Join our Community and enjoy additional community insights and crowdsourced detections, plus an API key to automate checks.

Security vendors' analysis

Do you want to automate checks?

Phishing Database	Phishing	Abusix	Clean
Acronis	Clean	ADMINUSLabs	Clean
AILabs (MONITORAPP)	Clean	AlienVault	Clean
Antiy-AVL	Clean	BitDefender	Clean
BlockList	Clean	Blueliv	Clean
Certego	Clean	Chong Lua Dao	Clean
CINS Army	Clean	CRDF	Clean
Criminal IP	Clean	CTX AI	Clean
Cyble	Clean	CyRadard	Clean
deseenmascara.me	Clean	DNSB	Clean
Dr.Web	Clean	EmergingThreats	Clean
Emsisoft	Clean	ESET	Clean

3) This alert aligns with the previous one. Escalating, so this can be used for fine tuning blocking.

1816

Access to Blacklisted External URL Blocked by Firewall

High

Firewall

Apr 25th 2026 at 22:53

Awaiting action

Description:

This alert was triggered when a user attempted to access an external URL that is listed in the organization's blacklist or threat intelligence feeds. The firewall or proxy successfully blocked the outbound request, preventing the connection. Note: The blacklist only covers known threats. It does not guarantee protection against new or unknown malicious domains.

datasource:

firewall

timestamp:

04/25/2026 22:51:25.540

Action:

blocked

SourceIP:

10.20.2.17

SourcePort:

34257

DestinationIP:

67.199.248.11

DestinationPort:

80

URL:

http://bit.ly/3sHkX3da12340

Application:

web-browsing

Protocol:

TCP

Rule:

Blocked Websites

New Search

Save As

Create Table View

Close

1 http://bit.ly/3sHkX3da12340

24 hour window

1 of 1 event matchedNo Event Sampling

Events (1)

Patterns

Statistics

Visualization

Format Timeline

Zoom Out

+ Zoom to Selection

X Deselect

1 hour per column

List

Format

50 Per Page

< Hide Fields

All Fields

SELECTED FIELDS

a host 1

a source 1

a sourcetype 1

INTERESTING FIELDS

a Action 1

a Application 1

a datasource 1

a DestinationIP 1

a DestinationPort 1

a index 1

a linecount 1

a Protocol 1

a punct 1

a Rule 1

a SourceIP 1

a SourcePort 1

a splunk_server 1

a timestamp 1

a URL 1

+ Extract New Fields

Time

Event

>

4/25/26

9:51:25.540 PM

{ [-]

Action: blocked

Application: web-browsing

DestinationIP: 67.199.248.11

DestinationPort: 80

Protocol: TCP

Rule: Blocked Websites

SourceIP: 10.20.2.17

SourcePort: 34257

URL: http://bit.ly/3sHkX3da12340

datasource: firewall

timestamp: 04/25/2026 22:51:25.540

}

Show as raw text

host = 1030.108.96.8989 | source = eventcollector | sourcetype = _json

- 4) This is a true positive. The email is typo-squatting as phishing. There is a sense of urgency within the tone of the email. When we query this link on Splunk, we see that the user has unfortunately accessed this link, and the link was not automatically blocked by the firewall. The user's account will need to be locked and reset now that the password to the account has been compromised. Additionally, this domain/IP address will need to be blocked to prevent access to this link in the future.

Assigned alert(s) Write case report

8817 Inbound Email Containing Suspicious External Link Medium Phishing Apr 25th 2026 at 22:54

Description: This alert was triggered by an inbound email contains one or more external links due to potentially suspicious characteristics. As part of the investigation, check firewall or proxy logs to determine whether any endpoints have attempted to access the URLs in the email and whether those connections were allowed or blocked.

datasource: email

timestamp: 04/25/2026 22:52:29.540

subject: Unusual Sign-In Activity on Your Microsoft Account

sender: no-reply@microsoftsupport.co

recipient: c.allen@thetrydaily.thm

attachment: None

content: Hi C.Allen,\n\nWe detected an unusual sign-in attempt on your Microsoft account.\n\nLocation: Lagos, Nigeria\n\nIP Address: 102.89.222.143\n\nDate: 2025-01-24 06:42\n\nIf this was not you, please secure your account immediately to avoid unauthorized access.\n\n<https://microsoftsupport.co/login>>Review Activity\n\nThank you,\n\nMicrosoft Account Security Team

direction: inbound

10-10-108-96.reverse-proxy-eu-west-1.tryhackme.com/en-US/app/search/search?earliest=rt-6h&latest=rtnow&q=search%20https%3A%2F%2Fmicrosoftsupport.co%2Flogin&display=...

splunk>enterprise Apps Messages Settings Activity Help Find

Search Analytics Datasets Reports Alerts Dashboards Search & Reporting

New Search Save As Create Table View Close

1 https://microsoftsupport.co/login 6 hour window

2 of 2 events matched No Event Sampling Job Zoom Out Zoom to Selection Deselect 1 hour per column

Events (2) Patterns Statistics Visualization

Format Timeline Zoom Out Zoom to Selection Deselect

1 hour per column

List Format 50 Per Page

< Hide Fields All Fields

SELECTED FIELDS

- a host 1
- a source 1
- a sourcetype 1

INTERESTING FIELDS

- a Action 1
- a Application 1
- a attachment 1
- a content 1
- a datasource 2
- a DestinationIP 1
- a DestinationPort 1
- a direction 1
- a index 1
- a linecount 1
- a Protocol 1
- a punct 2
- a recipient 1
- a rule 1
- a sender 1
- a SourceIP 1
- a SourcePort 1
- a splunk_server 1
- a subject 1
- a timestamp 2
- a URL 1

+ Extract New Fields

4/25/26 9:53:38.540 PM

[-]

Action: allowed

Application: web-browsing

DestinationIP: 45.148.10.131

DestinationPort: 443

Protocol: TCP

Rule: Allow-Internet

SourceIP: 10.20.2.25

SourcePort: 32653

URL: https://microsoftsupport.co/login

datasource: firewall

timestamp: 04/25/2026 22:53:38.540

Show as raw text

host = 10.10.108.96.8989 source = eventcollector sourcetype = _json

4/25/26 9:52:29.540 PM

[-]

attachment: None

content: Hi C.Allen,\n\nWe detected an unusual sign-in attempt on your Microsoft account.\n\nLocation: Lagos, Nigeria\n\nIP Address: 102.89.222.143\n\nDate: 2025-01-24 06:42\n\nIf this was not you, please secure your account immediately to avoid unauthorized access.\n\n<https://microsoftsupport.co/login>>Review Activity\n\nThank you,\n\nMicrosoft Account Security Team

datasource: email

direction: inbound

recipient: c.allen@thetrydaily.thm

sender: no-reply@microsoftsupport.co

subject: Unusual Sign-In Activity on Your Microsoft Account

timestamp: 04/25/2026 22:52:29.540

Show as raw text

host = 10.10.108.96.8989 source = eventcollector sourcetype = _json

Incident report

Incident classification



True positive



False positive

Case report

Please write a detailed report on the steps taken to analyse and contain this incident, including all relevant information and the rationale for its closure.

B *I* U **A** ▼ **≡** **≡** ▼

Time of activity: 04/25/2026 23:57:28.443

List of Affected Entities: c.allen@thetrydaily.thm

Reason for Classifying as True Positive: Typo-squatted domain, sense of urgency, misspelled email

Reason for Escalating the Alert: User has accessed domain, and the domain has not been blocoked

Recommended Remediation Actions: Lock c.allen@thetrydaily.thm and reset password, block domain and ip address

List of Attack Indicators: Typosquatted domain

Does this alert require escalation?



Yes



No